

DO ENGLISH WITH BRIAN

June — Three Conversations III

Expectation · Five Causes · The Conference

Three questions. No right answers — just your thoughts, in English.

*"Are you where you thought
you'd be by now?"*

지금의 나는, 예전에 그리던 그 모습에 와 있을까?

IF THE TALK SLOWS DOWN — DIG DEEPER

- At 20, where did you picture yourself today? How close is it?
- When your plan changed, did it feel like failure — or freedom?
- Whose expectations were you really chasing — yours, or someone else's?
- De Botton says rising expectations quietly breed anxiety. Do you feel that?

TOOLS — 막힐 때 잡는 표현

back then I thought ~ (그때 ~ 인 줄 알았다) looking back (돌아켜보면) it turned out ~ (~ 로 드러났다) not quite where I expected (기대만큼 아닌) settle for ~ (~ 로 만족하다 · 타협하다)

*"Of de Botton's five causes,
which weighs heaviest on you?"*

사랑결핍 · 속물근성 · 기대 · 능력주의 · 의존 (불확실성) — 어느 것이 가장 클까 ?

IF THE TALK SLOWS DOWN — DIG DEEPER

- Lovelessness / Snobbery / Expectation / Meritocracy / Dependence — rank your top one.
- Meritocracy says success is earned — so failure is deserved. Fair, or cruel?
- Dependence (의존 · 불확실성): our status rests on luck we can't control. Comforting, or scary?
- In Korean society specifically, which cause runs strongest — and why?

TOOLS — 막힐 때 잡는 표현

the biggest factor (가장 큰 요인) it comes down to ~ (결국 ~ 로 귀결된다) more than anything (무엇보다도) that outweighs ~ (~ 보다 더 크다)
I'd rank ~ first (~ 을 첫째로 꼽겠다)

"Standing before your peers at the conference — what does the anxiety feel like?"

학회에서 동료들 앞에 설 때, 그 불안은 어떤 모습일까?

IF THE TALK SLOWS DOWN — DIG DEEPER

- Presenting at IAS 2026 — whose approval are you hoping for, deep down?
- Which of the five causes hits hardest for you as a researcher?
- Your standing depends on reviewers, journals, funding — things you can't control. How do you sit with that?
- If a talk goes badly, does it threaten your worth — or just one bad day?

TOOLS — 막힐 때 잡는 표현

deep down (마음 깊은 곳에서) what scares me is ~ (내가 두려운 건 ~) put myself out there (용기 내어 나서다) live up to ~ (~ 에 부응하다) the impostor feeling (가면 증후군 같은 기분)